



Should you use an equalizer?

Well music is all about personal preference, and whatever sounds good to you is what you should use but here are some basic principles: <http://dgit.in/pushdtempo>

Ask Digit!

Having Tech difficulties? Check our colophone page on how to reach us, and see your queries answered on: <http://dgit.in/askdigit>

NZXT Source 530

Great case for the price



Features	78
Performance.....	76
Build Quality	68
Value for money	75

Specifications

Dimension: 235mm x 507mm x 510.5mm;
Motherboard Support: ITX, mATX, ATX, E-ATX;
Expansion Slots: 8; **Form Factor:** Full-tower; **Drive Bays:** (x3) 5.25", (x6+1) 3.5"/2.5"; **Included cooling fans:** Rear 1x140mm, Top 1x120mm fan; **Front I/O:** (x2) USB 3.0, **Weight:** 9.2kg;
Warranty: 2 years

Contact

PrimeABGB
Email: sales@primeabgb.com
Website: www.primeabgb.com
Phone: +91-98218 08900

NZXT has been known for their Phantom series of cases and we've actually tested quite a lot of them. What's synonymous with the Phantom range is the asymmetrical design which makes the cases look futuristic. While the Phantom series of cases are feature-rich, they're also quite expensive.

This is where the NZXT Source series comes into play by coming up with cabinets that are not only adequately feature rich but also considerably priced lower. The Source 530 – a full-tower – is the new top end case of the series. Looks wise, there is nothing special with the 530 but it does have a chunky sort of appeal. The whole case exterior is an amalgamation of plain black steel and glossy plastic with a good amount of mesh thrown into the mix. The front fascia is a big meshed panel which is recessed into a plastic frame with glossy plastic strips running along the outer rim of the face-plate. Front I/O options include two USB 3.0 ports, audio jacks, power and activity indication lights, power and reset buttons and also a rear I/O LED on/off switch. There is also a rear I/O LED which is a pretty useful feature because it lights up the rear I/O shield thus making ports visible and easier to work with, considering spaces underneath most desks are dimly lit.

The top of the case is laden with a huge grill to allow for mounting fans or liquid cooling radiators. The Source 530 can accommodate a total of up to three 120mm or two 140mm fans at the top or you also have the option to use the top space for installing a 240mm or 280mm liquid cooling radiator. Moving to the side of the Source 530, there is a big transparent acrylic side panel window. The bottom of the case has dust filters and big stands with rubber feet.

Though the exterior seems lackluster, it's the inside of the Source 530 where all the magic happens. First and foremost, the design of the motherboard tray is well thought out with a big cut-out for the CPU backplate area. Cable routing holes are aplenty on the motherboard tray and so we were able to do a very neat job with the cable management for our test setup. The next useful feature is the addition of a pivotable fan mount on the drive cage that allows you to install a 120mm fan and point it towards either the CPU or the GPU.

There are three drive cages in the Source 530 and these cages sit on top of each other while also being completely removable. Removing the drive cages makes room for yet another 240mm water cooling radiator. Even if you remove all the cages, you still have the option to mount an SSD inside the 530, behind the motherboard tray. Another great feature of the 530 has to be the included fan hub. This fan hub supports 10 fans, is appropriately placed behind the motherboard tray right beside the hidden SSD mount and it makes it very convenient to power all the fans inside the 530. The case has enough fan mounts to install a total of up to nine fans and the best part is that the case has removable dust filters for all the air-intake areas.

We set up our standard AMD Phenom II X4 955 BE rig within the case and the case gave us decent internal readings – 40°C while the CPU was under load at 45°C. All in all, the NZXT Source 530 is a wonderful case with all the features that an enthusiast would usually ask for and then some more. If you're someone who prefers function over form, and are on a tight budget, the Source 530 is a great choice.

The Corsair 400R available for ₹200, is another great option at this price point and a direct competitor to the Source 530 but the 530 edges it out by a small margin when it comes to features.

Siddhant Sharma